STATUS REPORT

Mauritius: status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Mauritius still ranks second of 54 African states for overall governance, but the direction has reversed: its Ibrahim Index score was 72.8 out of 100 in 2023, down 4.0 points since 2014 and off the first place it once held, with declines on 55 of the index's 96 indicators against improvements on 32 and public administration down 6.1 points to 72.2 (2023).

The response has been strategy, and a great deal of it. The long-horizon plan is Digital Mauritius 2030, adopted in December 2018. The Blueprint for Mauritius 2025-2029, released in May 2025, names data governance as an enabler and AI as a pillar, and commits the state to a unified government portal with single sign-on, a government super app, an integrated digital immigration system and a new hub-and-spoke data-exchange platform. A National Data Strategy 2025-2029 was launched on 28 January 2026, when the Data Protection Commissioner announced that a Freedom of Information Bill was being prepared, and a National Fintech Strategy 2026-2030 followed in June. Alongside them sits the earlier Digital Government Transformation Strategy 2018-2022.

Delivery is the thinner half. The World Bank records a current digital transformation strategy whose implementation is institutionalised rather than ad hoc (2025) and a data-governance function with an approved policy that sits inside another institution rather than standing as a body of its own (2025), alongside a dedicated institution responsible for digital government. Coordination has been added twice over: an inter-ministerial committee in August 2025 to drive the digital strategy, and a Project Monitoring and Implementation Unit under the Prime Minister's Office announced to Parliament in August 2026 which has no decision-making power of its own and can only coordinate, monitor and report bottlenecks. The ministry named its own weaknesses in April 2025: a slipping e-government ranking, personal data dispersed across government holdings, and a legal framework lagging behind practice.

Legislation and regulation

Mauritius's digital law now arrives largely inside budget legislation. The Economic and Financial Measures (Miscellaneous Provisions) Bill (No. XIII of 2026), dated 24 July 2026 and signed by Prime Minister and Finance Minister Navin Ramgoolam, amends 57 enactments and repeals one across its clauses 2 to 59, and is the companion to a 128-page Finance Bill executing the 2026-2027 budget.

The country's artificial-intelligence framework came the same way. Rather than an AI act, the bill inserts an AI City Scheme into the Economic Development Board Act, a scheme to establish a specialised technological and innovation hub whose certificate holders are entitled to prescribed fiscal incentives, duty exemptions and expedited permits. It puts the National Fintech Governance Committee on a statutory footing in a new Part IIIA of the Financial Services Act from 1 September 2026, and adds a section 34A to the Virtual Asset and Initial Token Offering Services Act

prohibiting unlicensed solicitation of investors by any medium, naming targeted advertising, apps, social media, influencers, affiliates and referral codes, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius. Commencement is staggered across eight fixed dates from June 2025 to January 2027, some provisions deemed retrospective and others left to Proclamation, so the digital provisions do not take effect together.

The hole runs through the same package: the Data Protection Act 2017 is not among the enactments amended and the bill carries no cross-reference to it, leaving the new state data handling it creates on a bare requirement to act in accordance with applicable data protection requirements, while the Finance Bill strengthens data exchange between administrations, which will need solid personal-data safeguards.

The standing stock is older and dispersed. The Information and Communication Technologies Act 2001 is the sector statute, under which the ICT Authority licenses internet service providers; the Computer Misuse and Cybercrime Act 2003 was repealed by the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021. Identity law sits in the National Identity Card Act, amended by successive Finance Acts and supplemented in 2024 by three sets of regulations including the Mobile ID Regulations. There is no dedicated data-exchange statute: inter-agency sharing rests on the Data Protection Act and the Electronic Transactions Act 2000. On a law firm's reading, the 2026 amendment to the electronic transactions Act recognises electronic transferable records and contracts formed by automated message systems. The ICT ministry held its working session with Meta on faster content removal, Kreol moderation and proposed amendments to the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act, with no framework yet signed (2026).

Data protection

Regulations made on 17 June 2026 formalise the designation, qualifications, independence and reporting duties of data protection officers across both the public and private sectors, with a six-month compliance window and entry into force on 1 January 2027. They sit under the Data Protection Act 2017, in force since 15 January 2018 and aligned with the EU General Data Protection Regulation, including on biometric data and data subject rights, which also requires controllers to notify the Commissioner of a personal data breach within 72 hours where feasible, and affected individuals where the risk is high.

Enforcement rests with the Data Protection Office, headed by Commissioner Drudeisha Madhub, who is also President of the Francophone Association of Data Protection Authorities. The office investigates complaints, issues enforcement notices and prosecutes, with appeal to the ICT Appeal Tribunal and an annual report to the National Assembly, but it cannot impose administrative fines, and its caseload — running to thousands of actions a year — is almost entirely resolved amicably. Mauritius is pursuing the European Union's adequacy assessment (2026).

The state's own record cuts the other way. Prime Minister Navin Ramgoolam has confirmed that illegal wiretapping took place, and the country's communications interception apparatus operated without judicial oversight, accessed by the Counter Terrorism Unit and the National Security Services. A recent case of data surfacing on the dark web is cited in the domestic argument over where data should sit (April 2026). In identity, the architecture was reshaped by adverse rulings — central storage of biometric data was held unconstitutional in 2015, and in 2021 the UN Human Rights Committee found that storing biometric data on identity cards violated the right to privacy — and since 19 February 2024 the National Identity Card Act has required an independent body to be appointed to carry out periodic security audits of the identity system. Against that, the 2026 budget bills expand what the state holds and shares, and the omnibus among them does so without amending the Act.

Regional collaboration

Mauritius's cross-border digital reach runs through payments and membership rather than shared systems. It participates in the Smart Africa Alliance. Its first payments corridor abroad is the link between the national switch and India's Unified Payments Interface, agreed in February 2024 as the country's first bilateral cross-border

payments arrangement; on the Southern African regional rail, Mauritius is among four countries considering onboarding their currencies to the SADC real-time gross settlement system, potentially by the end of 2027 (July 2026). What crosses borders on identity is the physical credential: COMESA partners accept the identity card for visa-free travel on a bilateral basis, and Mauritius waives visas for citizens of all COMESA states.

Standards

Cabinet took note on 28 August 2026 of a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service developed, procured or maintained, published by the Government Information Service; how compliance is checked is not stated.

The newest standard-setting body in Mauritian digital governance is being created without legal personality. The National Fintech Governance Committee is empowered to set national fintech priorities and to approve sector-wide standards and frameworks, but is expressly not a body corporate; it is chaired by the Minister and seats the Bank of Mauritius Governor, the Financial Services Commission chief executive, four ministries, the Economic Development Board and four private-sector members.

The general standard is much older. Mauritius has had a mandatory e-Government Interoperability Framework since 2002, one of the earliest in Africa, and the World Bank records the framework as extensively used rather than nominal (2025). Government technology is overseen by ministry-level chief information officers alongside a government-wide CIO function with a central advisory and research role (2025), and open source is only partially adopted, taken up in several sectors rather than government-wide (2025).

Below that, standards are set one regime at a time and usually by the sector's own regulator. The Bank of Mauritius's 2023 guideline on cyber and technology risk management requires banks and payment service providers to undergo external independent audits and penetration testing of critical systems, with results held supervisory rather than published. The critical information infrastructure designation regulations in force since 1 June 2026 put compliance duties on designated operators. The Mauritius Standards Bureau's national ISO/IEC 27001 certification scheme held ten valid certificates at 31 December 2025, among them CERT-MU, the Mauritius Revenue Authority's server room, the Central Information Systems Division, the Police IT Unit and the Emtel and Mauritius Telecom data centres. The AI strategy's FAIR Guidelines are non-binding.

Some of the standards work with the furthest reach is not the state's at all. Mauritius Telecom is a founding contributor and co-chair of TM Forum's MODaaS collaboration, announced on 20 July 2026, work to define controls and conformance criteria for a model-as-a-service certification framework that does not yet exist, and the chamber of commerce study on enterprise AI adoption carries governance — accountability, transparency, human oversight, data governance, intellectual property and the imputability of AI outputs — as a declared strand.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Digital freedom is Mauritius's weakest-ranked rights measure: 51.2 out of 100 and 25th of 54 African states in 2023, down 21.7 points since 2014, the lowest rank the country holds on any digital measure. It belongs to a wider slide — rights fell 18.1 points over 2014-2023 to 64.7, the largest ten-year fall of any of the index's sub-categories for Mauritius and the main driver of its overall decline, and media freedom fell 10.7 points to 68.7 (2023).

The formal channels are in place. Mauritius operates an e-participation platform for public consultation on government decisions (2025) and a citizen feedback mechanism for government services. They are being used on contested ground: following Cabinet on 5 June 2026 the technology ministry announced consultations toward a

mechanism to verify the identity of social-media users, aimed at disinformation, impersonation, defamatory content, scams and child sexual abuse material, and in doing so acknowledged the tension with privacy and free expression, the ease of circumvention by VPN and the need to negotiate with the platforms.

Argument outside government is pointed rather than deferential, and aimed at the government's central bet. A published Mauritian analysis argues that contract enforcement is a serious constraint on growth, and that justice reform, though less attractive than announcing a new AI strategy or launching another digital platform, may do more for the economy in the long run. Data is being argued as a strategic asset rather than an operating cost, and data sovereignty as a strategic question, with named practitioners pressing for critical state and enterprise data to be hosted within or close to the territory and for Mauritius to position itself as a regional cloud-and-cybersecurity hub.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Mauritius spent about a fifth of what it voted for its e-Health and e-Licensing builds in 2024-25 and nothing on its e-Passport project, while its Safe City line ran close to budget: the Accountant-General's accounts record Rs 52.5 million spent of Rs 260 million voted for hospital e-Health, Rs 43.3 million of Rs 210 million for the e-Licensing project and nothing of Rs 50 million for the e-Passport project, against Rs 876.4 million of Rs 950 million for the Safe City project (2024/25).

The digital lines of the 2026-27 estimates come to Rs 3.51 billion appropriated, up from Rs 3.20 billion in 2025-26 (2026/27).

The 2026-27 estimates print no financing source against their digital lines (2026/27). The investment programme beside them does name its financiers: the Public Sector Investment Programme for 2026-27 to 2030-31 directs its external grants and loans to water, port, airport, road, health and national-security projects, and labels one of its 33 e-government initiatives, an electronic catch-reporting system, as EU-funded.

The lines that keep the state's systems running are voted afresh each year. The 2026-27 estimates carry Rs 131.9 million for running the Government Online Centre, Rs 76.1 million for its data centre and Rs 40.5 million for its Tier IV data centre (2026/27), and Rs 125 million for the national identity card unit and Rs 1.1 billion for the Safe City project (2026/27). Cabinet put Rs 85 million a year behind free internet for households on the Social Register when the measure went live in February 2026.

Part of the state's hosting is moving to the operator: Mauritius Telecom's Tier IV centre at Rose-Belle is to host the e-Health system, the new government portal and Mobile ID, and to supply the backup the Government Online Centre lacks (December 2025). The commercial terms of that hosting had not been published as at September 2026.

MoUs and other agreements

The most prominent agreement of 2026 commits no money and names nothing anyone can be held to. Mauritius Telecom signed a memorandum of understanding with Amazon Web Services on 16 July 2026, aimed at skills, at helping businesses and public institutions turn ideas into solutions and at a pathway to scale for local innovators, with no disclosed value and no binding deliverable. On the same day Mauritius Telecom announced a partnership with SBM Bank to create a shared entrepreneur platform, without terms, value or a date by which anything is to exist. Both are statements of intent signed at the same industry event, and the distance between an announcement of this kind and a system in service is the whole of the work.

New investments

The largest external commitment on record to Mauritius's digital estate paid for a police surveillance system. On 1 April 2018 Mauritius Telecom, the minority state-owned operator, signed a preferential buyer's credit worth USD 73,687,000 with the Export-Import Bank of China to part-finance the Safe City Project, and the Government of Mauritius issued a sovereign guarantee for it — putting the state behind an operator's borrowing for a camera network. The credit was extended on concessional terms rather than commercial ones, with a long maturity and a grace period before repayment began, and USD 22,349,375 of it was outstanding at 30 June 2018, three months after signature and the first year-end the loan appears in. The guarantee outlives the equipment: a facility of that length leaves the state carrying a surveillance contract's financing long after the cameras it bought have been replaced.

What has followed is policy rather than lending. Mauritius published a National Fintech Strategy 2026-2030 on 25 June 2026, developed with UN ECA support and built on six pillars, with implementation coordinated among the financial regulators, the Bank of Mauritius and private-sector stakeholders. Private money reaching the sector arrives largely through the island's role as an intermediary rather than as a destination: since its exit from the FATF grey list, Mauritius has been used by fintechs as a treasury and billing gateway into fragmented African markets.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Internet and computer access is the single most improved of the 96 measures in Mauritius's Ibrahim Index profile, up 33.3 points over 2014-2023 to 88.7 out of 100 and second of 54 African states (2023) — while over the same decade Mauritians' own assessment of their infrastructure fell 25.6 points to 74.4, one of the country's ten most deteriorated indicators (2023). Infrastructure is one of the few parts of the governance record still improving, at 79.4 out of 100 and third in Africa (2023), even as the overall score fell, and mobile communications rose 10.1 points to 85.3 (2023).

Household internet access reached 85.8% (2024), up from 72.6% in 2020 and 29.0% in 2010; 79.5% of the population used the internet (2023), and mobile connections stood at around 161% of the population (early 2024). Internet subscriptions numbered roughly 1.01 million (January 2025), and fibre-to-the-home access cost 1.8% of GNI per capita (2022).

The island lands on the SAFE, LION, LION2 and METISS submarine systems (2025), with the Mauritius Internet Exchange Point hosted in extended form at the Rogers Capital data centre in Ébène (July 2025). SAFE is due to retire around 2027 and a replacement, T4, is planned (July 2025), alongside new submarine cables and a 5G-Advanced rollout under Mauritius Telecom's 2026-2029 strategy (December 2025). The government announced in July 2026 that Mauritius would join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme, after discussions between the two prime ministers in New Delhi in February 2026.

The dedicated broadband policy is the National Broadband Policy 2012-2020, whose window closed in 2020, and the sector regulator is the ICT Authority, which licenses service providers under the 2001 ICT Act. Not all the network the state has built serves connectivity: the Safe City project as commissioned equips the police with 4,000 surveillance cameras on main roads, motorways and walkways and 4,500 smartphones, across five linked systems including a central watch and management system and an intelligent command system. The weakest infrastructure measure is shipping and postal capacity, down 17.0 points over the decade to 45.1 out of 100 (2023).

Data Storage

Mauritius Telecom's Rose-Belle data centre is certified Tier IV and is to host strategic state systems (December 2025), among them the e-Health system, the new government portal, Mobile ID, the penalty-points system and government AI equipment. It matters because government data systems have been hosted at the Government Online Centre in Ébène since 2005, and that site, grown to about 80 racks and under pressure, lacked a fully operational backup, which Rose-Belle is meant to supply (December 2025).

Ten data centres were operating across five locations — Port Louis, Réduit, Arsenal, Quatre Bornes and Rose-Belle (July 2025), the commercial estate spread across several private operators, among them Aphelion, Rogers Capital, Harel Mallac Technologies at Tier III, Emtel at Arsenal and BIRGER's Candos recovery facility, with Bhumishq at Réduit carrier-neutral and designed to Tier IV. What the island does not have is a hyperscale cloud region of its own, so the global cloud platforms serve it from distant regions.

Government itself runs a private cloud on one shared platform, delivered to public bodies as a service (2025), and the stated driver of the arrangement is keeping government data inside the country (2025) — an ambition already in the 2018 long-horizon strategy, which provided for resilient public-service data centres. The state operator is building an AI and compute corridor, expanding its Tier IV-certified data centre with dedicated GPU clusters and a sovereign cloud (July 2026), a direction contested at home on the argument that an infrastructure-first bet risks obsolescence on delivery, and that AI services should be built now on hybrid cloud (March 2026).

The pitch to foreign capital is a special economic zone at Côte-d'Or designated for AI and digital activity — 83 arpents, preferential electricity tariffs for data centres, 30-year renewable leases and 100% foreign ownership (June 2026). Practitioners in the sector argue that critical state and enterprise data should be held within or close to the territory, and that Mauritius should position itself as a regional cloud and cybersecurity hub, on the ground that local or regional hosting clarifies which law applies, who may intervene and how liability is contracted (April 2026).

Energy

Near-universal access has not made the supply outage-free: 41.6% of the 353 formal-sector firms surveyed for the World Bank's 2023 enterprise survey reported at least one power outage in the previous fiscal year, most often at roughly monthly frequency. Access itself is effectively complete, with 99.7% of the population connected to the grid (2023), scoring 99.3 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index's energy measure (2023). Renewables supplied about 24% of electricity (2023), under the Renewable Energy Roadmap 2030, supported by net-billing and subsidised household solar schemes (2024). Energy and water are now among the five sectors in the first phase of critical information infrastructure designation (June 2026), which brings the utilities' own control systems inside the cyber regime.

Technical Capacity

The government told Parliament in August 2026 that it was consulting to recruit experienced engineering and project-management professionals, possibly including one from abroad, for a new unit set up to identify the delays and blockages in major public projects. The same reliance runs through the identity estate, where the current national identity system was built by a Thales-led consortium with the local firm Harel Mallac Technologies while day-to-day operation sits with the National Identity Card Unit in the Prime Minister's Office (2024) — foreign build, domestic control. The institutional scaffolding is in place: ministry-level chief information officers and a government-wide CIO function with a central advisory and research role (2025), and a public sector innovation strategy with a programme to deliver it (2025), though the government's own HR management system still carries manual processes and paperwork (2025).

Cybersecurity

Cabinet noted on 22 May 2026 the promulgation of Critical Information Infrastructure Designation Regulations, in force from 1 June 2026, closing a gap in which the state could prosecute cybercriminals but had no framework for designating and regulating operators of critical systems. The first phase covers five sectors — financial services and banking, the public service, ICT and broadcasting, energy and water, and transport — and operators have twelve months from entry into force to comply. Designation runs through the National Cybersecurity Committee in consultation with the sector regulators, with owners bound by confidentiality and authorised-access directives; the Committee holds enforcement authority alongside law enforcement agencies, and non-compliance carries up to 25 years' imprisonment and fines of up to Rs 2 million.

The parent statute is the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021 and the standing policy the National Cyber Security Strategy 2023-2026, published through CERT-MU. Mauritius sits in the top 'role-modelling' tier of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, reserved for states with an overall score of at least 95 out of 100.

A second perimeter is being drawn from another direction. A Bill dated 24 July 2026 would empower the Bank of Mauritius to establish a Cyber Threat Intelligence Sharing Platform for financial institutions, with participation compulsory on terms the Bank determines and the perimeter extensible to "such other institutions as the Bank may specify" — the central bank, not the cyber authority, deciding who is inside it.

In banking, external independent audit and penetration testing of critical systems have been required since the Bank of Mauritius's 2023 cyber and technology risk guideline, though results stay supervisory and no independent audit of MauCAS is published. The 2026-2027 budget funds a Cyber Forensic laboratory at Rs 13 million and an information security management system across the public administration, and a ministerial mission in May 2026 announced a cybersecurity working framework for Rodrigues. Behind the urgency sits a recent case of data surfacing on the dark web, cited in the domestic data-sovereignty argument, and the consultations announced in June 2026 on a mechanism to verify the identity of social-media users.

DPI

Data Exchange

Mauritius's July 2026 Finance Bill widens data sharing between administrations, which will need solid personal-data safeguards, and it does so on top of an exchange layer that has been running for nearly a decade. InfoHighway, the national data-exchange platform, has been live since August 2016 and connected 33 government publisher organisations through 192 system connections supporting more than 600 e-services as at 2025.

The design is deliberately thin. It is a publisher-subscriber model that stores no data of its own, fetching records live from source databases, running on the government intranet from the Government Online Centre under a High-Level Management Team chaired by the technology ministry, and a connection is made only after a signed agreement or memorandum of understanding between the agencies concerned and central approval (2024). There is no dedicated data-exchange statute: the sharing rests on the Data Protection Act 2017 and the Electronic Transactions Act 2000, alongside a mandatory e-Government Interoperability Framework in place since 2002. The World Bank records the framework as extensively used rather than nominal (2025).

What crosses is mostly identity and revenue. The Civil Status Division publishes citizen records, so other agencies verify users' information against civil registration at source (2023), and the Central Population Database reaches the Mauritius Revenue Authority, the Economic Development Board and the National Transport Authority (2024). The Corporate and Business Registration Department is a listed publisher, so business registration data can be queried in real time (2025). The showpiece is the Negative Income Tax, in which the revenue authority draws civil status

records over the platform to identify eligible low-income employees and deliver the benefit automatically (2025). Separately, customs, tax administration, debt management, financial management, human resources and social insurance exchange data both through a Government Service Bus and through point-to-point interfaces (2025). A live public factsheet on the platform's homepage reports publisher agencies, active connections, e-services and query volumes (2026).

Digital Identity and CRVS

Following Cabinet on 5 June 2026, the technology ministry announced consultations toward a mechanism to verify the identity of social-media users, aimed at disinformation, impersonation, scams and child sexual abuse material — verification pushed past what the foundational system was built for.

That system is close to universal and compulsory by statute. World Bank data show 99.1% of Mauritians aged 15 and over held a national identity card or equivalent foundational document in 2021, and section 4(1)(a) of the National Identity Card Act requires every citizen to apply within six months of turning 18, with non-compliance an offence, while the Mobile ID remains optional. A unique National Identity Number is generated automatically when a birth is registered and deactivated when the death is registered (2019).

The credential carries weight. Production of the card or the Mobile ID is sufficient wherever a person is required to prove identity, under section 7(2). It is required for the Basic Retirement Pension, Widow's Pension, Social Aid and other social security benefits, and identifies beneficiaries in the Social Register (2024), and for SIM registration, where operators verify the photograph against the card (2024). MauPass, live since December 2020, registers citizens by card number, validating them against the Central Population Database (2024). Memoranda of understanding between the Bank of Mauritius, the Registrar of Civil Status, the police and the technology ministry provide for a Central KYC system reachable through InfoHighway, giving the central bank access to the Central Population Database (2023). A digital driving licence was soft-launched on the government app on 29 September 2026, with legal effect from 1 January 2027; access needs a fully activated MauPass account.

The third-generation card, MNIC 3.0, arrived in February 2024, and a Mobile ID wallet in September 2024, built with Thales technology and delivered through the MWA app, through which holders can view their own record, change a residential address and declare a lost card (2024). Biometrics stay constrained by litigation: fingerprints and a high-resolution facial image are captured at enrolment, but fingerprint data is stored only on the card and not centrally, following a 2015 Supreme Court ruling (2024). Ease of obtaining an identity document still ranks 1st of 54 African states at 84.6 out of 100, but has fallen 15.1 points since 2014 (2023).

Digital Payments and Fintech

Two of the flows a national instant rail is meant to carry are still missing: government-to-person disbursements and business-to-business payments are not enabled on Mauritius's instant payment system and sit only on the roadmap (2024).

The rest has been in place for years. MauCAS, the Mauritius Central Automated Switch, has run an instant payment system nationwide since August 2019, offering 24/7 account-to-account and QR payments across banks and payment service providers (2024). Person-to-person transfers into bank accounts and mobile wallets are its most used transaction type, alongside merchant QR payments and person-to-government payments for licence fees, fines and customs (2024). The Bank of Mauritius owns and runs it outright, as system operator, scheme manager and overseer (2024): rules, rail and supervision in one institution.

Around 80% of adults made or received a digital payment in the previous year (2021), access to banking services scores 63.5 out of 100, first of 54 African states and up 14.6 points over 2014-2023 (2023), and QR payments at the Mauritius Commercial Bank rose 67% year on year in 2025.

The central bank has linked MauCAS to India's Unified Payments Interface through a network-to-network agreement, letting travellers pay by MauCAS QR with settlement in Indian rupees (2024), the country's first bilateral cross-border payments arrangement. Meanwhile the Angolan kwanza became the second settlement currency of the SADC real-time gross settlement system on 27 July 2026, the first addition since the rail launched rand-only in 2013, and the Botswana pula and the Mozambican metical are named as the next currencies, while Mauritius is among four countries considering onboarding theirs, potentially by the end of 2027 (July 2026); admission turns on liquidity, because the central bank behind each settlement currency supplies liquidity in it when the system runs short.

Policy has caught up in 2026. A National Fintech Strategy 2026-2030 was published on 25 June 2026, developed with UN ECA support, and a new Part IIIA of the Financial Services Act commencing 1 September 2026 puts the National Fintech Governance Committee on a statutory footing, chaired by the Minister and seating the central bank Governor, the Financial Services Commission chief executive, four ministries, the Economic Development Board and four private-sector members.

Registries

Three new registers arrive in a single instrument. The Economic and Financial Measures (Miscellaneous Provisions) Bill No. XIII of 2026, dated 24 July 2026, creates a national land transport database, kept by a new Traffic Management and Road Safety Unit under the Road Traffic Act, and provides for online registration of vehicle ownership transfers, establishes a beneficial-ownership register of partnerships, and creates clinical-trial disease registries, research databases and epidemiological surveillance under a new Public Clinical Trial Unit.

Land is the standout. The cadastral database built under the Land Administration, Valuation and Information Management System covers the whole island with digital aerial imagery and assigns a mandatory Parcel Identification Number to every land deed. Over 547,000 cadastral parcels are captured, making Mauritius one of only three African countries whose land registry covers more than half of all private land (2023), and the Registrar General's e-Registry allows online registration, payment and search of registry documents including land and property records (2024).

The Central Population Database is compiled directly from births, deaths, marriages and changes of citizenship under sections 8A to 8C of the Civil Status Act, so the population register is built from civil registration by statute rather than merely linked to it. Civil registration scores 75.0 out of 100 in 2023, 7th of 54 African states, and has not moved at all across the 2014-2023 decade. The register's boundary is citizenship: section 8B confines the database to citizens, so resident non-citizens are not recorded in the national population register.

The Corporate and Business Registration Department runs the business register as a digital service, with online incorporation, registration and public search (2026). For the November 2024 National Assembly election the roll held 1,002,857 registered voters against a voting-age population of 1,064,944, compiled annually by a door-to-door update under the Representation of the People Act, and the Electoral Commissioner publishes a continuously updated digital Register of Electors broken down by constituency, ward, polling station, sex, age and citizenship (2024). Joining up is by identifier rather than by system: the revenue authority's register identifies individuals by their identity card number and businesses by their Business Registration Number or Tax Account Number (2025).

Sectoral management information systems

Health has one site under test. The Ministry of Health and Wellness's e-Health project was under test at the Sir Anerood Jugnauth Hospital from 23 August 2025, with rollout to the remaining regional hospitals to follow a successful test. The project sits under a Roadmap for Digital Health Transformation prepared with UNDP support (2025).

The finance and revenue back office is another matter. A financial management information system on commercial off-the-shelf software is in use across both central and sub-national government, covering treasury, budget and other functions, and the treasury system is recorded as extensively used by all ministries, departments and agencies, with government payments settled through real-time gross settlement (2025). Tax administration runs on commercial software connected to other government systems through the Government Service Bus, customs on commercial software, payroll on custom software, and electronic procurement covers online tendering and contract management and is interfaced with other government systems (2025). Social insurance and pensions run on custom software with records fully digitised (2025).

One admission sits inside that record. The financial management system carries programme performance indicators for only some programmes rather than across the budget as a whole (2025).

Elsewhere the line ministries do run real systems. OpenEMIS is the national education management information system, with student and staff profiles, attendance, enrolment and academic performance entered directly by administrators at national, zonal and school level, following a 2022 UNESCO-supported capacity-building programme for ministry staff (2022). Policing is mid-replacement: the 2025-2026 budget allocates Rs 43 million to replace the Crime Occurrence Tracking System with a new police case management system and to add biometric capability to the Criminal Attribute Database, with tendering opening at the end of August 2025. The platform's country account reported DHIS2 in use at regional and national level, with extension to district and primary care level still planned (2022).

The force's 2021 policing plan put use of the system up from 30% to over 80% of divisions in 2020, with full use targeted for 2021. A 2023 press account dates the replacement of handwritten occurrence books by computer entries to 2015.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Mauritius scores 42.2 out of 100 for ease of resolving a commercial dispute in the World Bank's Business Ready 2025 assessment, against Singapore's 73.3, the comparator it sets for itself, with 49.0 against 66.0 on the quality of dispute-resolution regulation and 46.4 against 62.8 on the public services supporting it, the largest gap falling in the efficiency of commercial litigation and alternative dispute resolution. Statistics Mauritius reported more than 70,000 cases pending before the courts at the end of 2025, over 13,000 of them civil — the queue that online filing does not shorten.

What the state offers at the counter is broad and genuinely transactional. A central e-services portal at govmu.org carries ministry services and electronic payments to government (2025), and the national online service portal is transactional at level 3 or 4, so citizens complete transactions rather than only download forms or read information (2025). An online tax portal covers taxpayer registration, filing, payment and further services (2025), with the revenue authority running individual income tax e-filing and a File and Pay service (2025). An online social protection portal covers registration, benefit information and payments (2025), and a separate public employment job portal handles recruitment, selection and online applications (2025). Mauritius scored 0.7506 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, in the very high band and among the leading African states.

Behind the counter, a dedicated GovTech institution responsible for digital government is established (2025). A Project Monitoring and Implementation Unit under the Prime Minister's Office was announced to Parliament in August 2026, to track delays, regulatory blockages and cost overruns on major public-infrastructure projects through integrated planning and data-driven monitoring, though its mandate is to coordinate, monitor and report bottlenecks rather than to decide anything.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The Rodrigues Regional Assembly launched a digital roadmap of its own, the Rod-Digital Vision, on 6 May 2026, built on four pillars: trust, innovation, sustainability and resilience. Later that month a ministerial mission to Port Mathurin announced a working framework for the island, notably for cybersecurity, with a team based in Mauritius, an intended cybersecurity and artificial intelligence representative on Rodrigues, and monthly meetings envisaged.

Rural digital data capture

The health ministry's e-Health project has not reached the rural primary network of area health centres, community health centres and mediclinics: it was under test at the Sir Anerood Jugnauth Hospital from 23 August 2025, to be rolled out next in the remaining regional hospitals.

The limit is not reach. The electricity grid covers effectively the whole population, and household internet access has climbed steeply since 2010; what varies is whether the office at the far end of that connection creates its records digitally. Civil registration is the older illustration: births, deaths and marriages were registered through a network of offices spanning the main island, Rodrigues and Agalega, only a subset of them computerised, with paper entries routed through a computerised office before the document came back to the applicant (2012).

Where capture outside the capital is digital, it is digital system by system rather than across the board. Education data is entered at school level through OpenEMIS instead of travelling to the centre as forms for re-keying. Police stations, rural ones included, have computers running the crime occurrence tracking system introduced in 2011 and terminals reaching the criminal records database. Mauritius Post agents on Rodrigues are to promote the KOREK! government super-app, and MauPass integration has been reviewed with them (May 2026).

Rural Mauritius is also close to unmeasured from outside: the country carries no score in the rural economy sub-category of the 2024 Ibrahim Index, or in any of its four indicators — rural land and water access, market access, economy support, and representation and participation — the only one of the index's sixteen sub-categories on which Mauritius cannot be scored.

Technology

AI

The Mauritius AI Registry at airegistry.mu went live on 9 July 2026, a directory of Mauritius-relevant AI models, agents and skills that does not host what it lists, each entry carrying provider identity, local-context relevance and, where applicable, institutional validation, and its software stack is open-sourced. It is run by Mauritius Telecom, the state operator, not by a ministry or a regulator, and the same operator runs mytGPT and its mytGPT Education service (July 2026), the platform its compute build is anchored on. Deployment into schools has already been rewritten once in contact with its users: the operator narrowed the service from a student-facing tutor to a coach for teachers after teacher and parent resistance (July 2026). The operator's AllMyT Summit in July 2026 drew over 1,000 participants, with the Prime Minister at its opening ceremony.

The terms attached to running AI arrived with the strategy rather than from a regulator. The FAIR Guidelines, issued with the AI for Mauritius strategy in April 2026, govern by impact rather than by geography: they are vendor-neutral and border-agnostic, require bias audits in fintech and gaming, and place locally-based-representative duties on foreign AI providers serving Mauritius. They are not binding, and sit on a stated trajectory towards legal force (April 2026). Certification of models is being built somewhere else again: Mauritius Telecom co-chairs TM Forum work to define controls and conformance criteria for a model-as-a-service certification framework that does not yet exist (July 2026).

None of it rests on a measurement of uptake. Mauritius has no measured baseline of enterprise AI adoption — which firms use it, in which sectors, with what skills — and the study to produce one was commissioned in late July 2026 by the chamber of commerce and industry bodies, after the national strategy and after the budget. The state has held an AI strategy since 2018, and AI is named 35 times in the 2026-2027 budget speech (June 2026), which measures how central it is to the stated programme and nothing else.

ICT Industry

Mauritius is legislating a technology sector into being rather than reporting one it has. Bill No. XIII of 2026 inserts an AI City Scheme into the Economic Development Board Act, to establish a specialised technological and innovation hub and promote investment in artificial intelligence, digital sectors and advanced computing infrastructure, with prescribed fiscal incentives, duty exemptions and expedited permits for certificate holders, and adds an AI Founder category at USD 1 million invested to the Act's permit criteria (2026). Budget 2026-2027 adds an investment tax credit of 15% a year over three years, 45% in all, for manufacturers investing in AI solutions, and designates a special economic zone at Côte-d'Or for AI and digital activity (June 2026).

What is measured is the environment rather than the firms. Mauritius has Africa's strongest business and competition regulations on the Ibrahim Index, scoring 92.6 out of 100 in 2023, first of 54 and up 5.3 points over the decade. The World Bank's 2025 assessment records that Mauritius supports GovTech start-ups and has public-private arrangements for delivering government services online, naming no scheme, contract or firm. The largest technology procurement on the public record went abroad and without competition: the Safe City project began as an unsolicited bid by Huawei in 2015, with the commercial contract signed in December 2017, ahead of the loan agreement.

Innovation ecosystem

The startup sector is small, and the large rounds attributed to the island reflect its role as a holding domicile for pan-African operators rather than homegrown activity (2024) — a distinction that matters wherever Mauritian venture figures are read as Mauritian output. Mauritius ranked 55th in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024.

Innovation inside the state is the better-established half. The World Bank's 2025 assessment records both a public sector innovation strategy and a programme to deliver it, alongside an established innovation function covering digital skills and public service innovation, though it names none of the three. Private incubation runs through a small set of active hubs, among them Turbine, a member of the pan-African AfriLabs network (2020). The newest route in is immigration rather than incubation, the AI City Scheme's AI Founder permit setting an investment threshold that selects for capital brought in over firms grown at home.

Capacity

Literacy

Mauritius has the best education record in Africa and is slowly spending it down: 85.4 out of 100 in 2023, first of 54 countries, and 4.3 points lower than in 2014. The decline sits in what schooling produces rather than what goes into it. Human resources for education scored 99.9 and enrolment 79.8, both the highest on the continent, and completion 97.0, second of 54; education quality also ranked second at 83.9, but had fallen 4.9 points over the decade (2023). A country that staffs and fills its classrooms better than any other in Africa is not one where reading ability is what stops a citizen using a digital service; the constraint, if it arrives, will come through quality rather than access.

Beyond the main island, digital awareness work aimed at young people on Rodrigues forms part of the island's integration into the national AI and cybersecurity strategy (May 2026).

Training and skills

Budget 2026-2027 commits Mauritius to training 50,000 people in artificial intelligence within a year: 25,000 professionals, 12,000 Grade-9 pupils, 8,000 teachers and 5,000 civil servants (June 2026). The same budget funds a National AI Learning Platform at Rs 25 million and scales MyT-GPT Education out of its pilot and into secondary schools (June 2026).

That pilot is recent and small: Mauritius Telecom launched a mytGPT Education pilot in January 2026, tested in ten schools. What it is for has already changed. The operator narrowed the deployment from a student-facing tutor to a teacher coach — homework auto-correction from a phone photograph, custom exam generation — after resistance from teachers and parents, and now aims at a personal AI assistant for every secondary school teacher by 2027 (July 2026). The retreat is the more informative fact: the constraint on AI in Mauritian classrooms was not the technology or the connectivity but the people expected to work alongside it, which is the same constraint the budget's 8,000-teacher training target now runs into.

Underneath the AI push sits steadier provision. Mauritius has a digital skills strategy and a digital skills programme for the public service, covering basic digital skills and data literacy, with part of it delivered on a fee-paying basis (2025). Training has also followed particular systems rather than skills in general: a UNESCO-supported programme for Ministry of Education staff put administrators at national, zonal and school level into direct entry on the national education management system (2022).

Research institutions

Mauritius had no dedicated public research institution or national research programme for digital technology or artificial intelligence as at August 2026.

Inclusion

Access to services

Equality of access is slipping from a high base: equal access to public services scored 84.2 out of 100 in 2023 and 2nd of 54 African states, but has fallen 15.7 points since 2014, part of a 6.0-point decline in the Ibrahim Index's Inclusion and Equality sub-category, which stands at 71.0.

Citizenship, not cost, is the gate. Almost every adult citizen holds a foundational identity document (2021) and the card is compulsory from the age of 18, but the National Identity Card Act restricts it to citizens, and section 8B of the Civil Status Act confines the Central Population Database to citizens too, so resident non-citizens are not recorded

in the national population register (2022). That restriction reaches into the welfare system, because the card is the mandatory document for the Basic Retirement Pension, Widow's Pension, Social Aid and other Ministry of Social Security benefits, and identifies beneficiaries in the Social Register of Mauritius (2024). For those who are eligible the barrier is low: first issue of the card is free of charge (2019), and the electoral roll is rebuilt each year by a door-to-door update under the Representation of the People Act (2024).

Reaching services online is affordable — Statistics Mauritius put the fibre-to-the-home tariff at 1.8% of GNI per capita in 2022, down from 2.2% in 2021 — and financial access is the strongest leg of the whole picture, with the highest score in Africa on access to banking services (2023) sitting on a national instant-payment switch, MauCAS, on which QR payments are a major use case (2024). The state's own commitment is newer and still on paper: the Blueprint for Mauritius 2025-2029 adopts a mobile-first, no-one-left-behind framing and promises a Government Super App.

Digital divides

Mauritius publishes least about the people most likely to be left out: social statistics are the weakest part of its open data, with food security scoring 3 out of 10, poverty and health outcomes 3.5, crime 4, and gender statistics and education facilities 4.5 in the 2024 Open Data Inventory. The lines a divide would fall along — sex, income, health, schooling — are the ones the national figures describe worst.

What is measured shows the physical barriers largely gone. Electricity reaches 99.7% of the population (2023). Household internet access reached 85.8% in 2024, up from 72.6% in 2020 and 29.0% in 2010, which still leaves roughly one household in seven off the network, and individual use sits lower again at 79.5% of the population in 2023. The improvement has been the fastest of anything the country does: internet and computer access is the most improved of the 96 measures in its 2024 Ibrahim Index profile, up 33.3 points over 2014-2023 to 88.7 out of 100 and 2nd of 54 African states (2023).

The divide that remains legible is geographic. The Rodrigues Regional Assembly launched its own digital roadmap, the Rod-Digital Vision, on 6 May 2026, built on trust, innovation, sustainability and resilience — a separate plan for an island where the government super-app is being promoted through post office agents (May 2026), a decade after the main island's own access figures began their climb. Capacity is not what holds the island back: the MARS cable to Rodrigues, in service since 2019 under a 20-year US$44.8m contract, had 19.9 of its 100 Gbps sold at 30 June 2025, with no ICT strategic plan for the island and the company formed to operate the cable still not running.

Data

National statistics

Mauritius's statistical system ranks third in Africa and is losing ground: capacity scored 78.1 out of 100 in 2023, down 11.4 points since 2014, one of the country's sharpest losses of administrative capability over the decade. The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators put the weakness in the inputs rather than the output: data use scores above 89% while data sources — the censuses, surveys and administrative and geospatial data the system runs on — score only 50-69% (2023), with services, products and infrastructure sitting between the two at 70-89%.

Dissemination has moved where compilation has not: the country adopted the enhanced tier of the IMF's data dissemination standard in March 2026, the first African country to join it, having graduated to the standard itself in February 2012, and the central bank launched a central statistical database on 3 September 2026, built with the IMF and the African Development Bank; the statistics statute and the central bank statute are being reviewed to strengthen the framework and reinforce central bank independence, on the prime minister's account. No series list, update cadence or licence is stated for the database.

The census record itself is complete: a population census, an agricultural census and a business census have all been run within the past ten years (2023). The survey programme around them is lopsided — three or more household surveys and three or more labour force surveys over that decade and one health survey, but no agricultural survey and no business survey at all. Administrative sources carry more of the load than that gap suggests: aggregate vital statistics are compiled centrally in electronic form every month, whether or not the civil status office that recorded the entry kept it on paper (2012); schools, zones and the ministry enter enrolment, attendance and performance directly into a national OpenEMIS deployment; and the Bank of Mauritius reports MauCAS transaction volumes and values at least annually.

The sharpest gap is in what the state has not counted at all. The chamber of commerce and the ICT industry body launched a study of AI adoption, readiness and governance among Mauritian firms in late July 2026 because there is no clear picture of how far adoption has gone, which sectors it touches, or what skills exist — the first measurement of the question, and it comes from outside government. Movement inside government is in the other direction: the Finance Bill before parliament in July 2026 widens what Statistics Mauritius passes to the Ministry of Finance and shortens the deadlines for producing the public accounts, part of a broader expansion of inter-agency data sharing that will need solid personal-data safeguards.

Open data

What the Mauritian state discloses and what a citizen can actually get hold of have moved in opposite directions over 2014-2023: disclosure of public records rose 25.1 points to 70.6 out of 100 and second place in Africa, while accessibility of those same records fell 12.4 points to 45.5, twelfth in Africa and now among the country's ten worst-scoring indicators.

The open-by-default position is nine years old — a National Open Data Policy was adopted in 2017 — and the machinery under it remains light: the open data portal carries basic information and datasets and is refreshed weekly or daily, but publication to it is still a largely manual process rather than an automated feed from source systems (2025). What is published is middling on the economy and poor on people: economic and environmental categories cluster between 5 and 7 out of 10, built environment and population highest at 7 and banking lowest at 5, while social statistics are the weakest of all — food security at 3, poverty and health outcomes at 3.5, crime at 4, gender statistics and education facilities at 4.5 (2024).

Across every area of the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index assessment — cloud, interoperability, the core administrative systems, the service and tax portals, data governance, data protection, right to information, digital skills, innovation and start-up support — Mauritius reports its supporting documentation as existing but internal and not published, with no area reporting it as published (2025).

Where publication does happen it can be very good: the Electoral Commissioner keeps a continuously updated digital Register of Electors broken down by constituency, ward, polling station, sex, age and citizenship, and InfoHighway carries a live public factsheet of connected agencies, e-services and query volumes. The right to ask is the piece still outstanding: a Freedom of Information Bill was announced as in preparation at the launch of the National Data Strategy 2025-2029 on 28 January 2026.

Use of satellite data

The state's one established use of earth observation is the land record: the cadastral database built under the Land Administration, Valuation and Information Management System covers the whole island in digital aerial imagery and assigns a mandatory Parcel Identification Number to every land deed, following a rollout completed between 2006 and 2011.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The clearest American commitment on the record is a soft one: Mauritius Telecom signed a memorandum of understanding with Amazon Web Services on 16 July 2026, aimed at skills, at helping businesses and public institutions turn ideas into solutions and at a pathway to scale for local innovators, with no value and no binding deliverable disclosed. An arrangement of that shape gives the platform a standing channel into government and into the training pipeline while committing it to nothing a reader can measure later.

American hardware sits further down the stack, and it reaches Mauritius through one supplier. Mauritius Telecom has attached its data-centre compute plans to NVIDIA, saying in February 2026 that it had met the company's senior leadership while seeking accelerators and returning to the same supplier in July. On the network side, the Prime Minister announced on 16 July 2026 that Mauritius will join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme, positioning the island as a digital gateway on the Asia-Africa corridor. Taken together the American footprint is an agreement, a chip supply line and an announced cable — access and dependency in prospect rather than infrastructure operated on the island. The incumbent operator and the cloud company held an executive workshop on cloud, data and artificial intelligence for more than 125 delegates of state-owned enterprises (2026).

China activities

Huawei's position in Mauritius began with the company's own proposal rather than a tender: the Safe City project originated in an unsolicited bid Huawei made to the government in 2015, the commercial contract was signed in December 2017 ahead of the loan agreement that funded it, and Huawei is the contractor responsible for implementation. The vendor that proposed the system also built it, and the financing was arranged around a contract that already existed.

That financing was a preferential buyer's credit from the Export-Import Bank of China carrying a sovereign guarantee — the largest single commitment in the recorded financing of the Mauritian digital estate, and still live eight years after signature. What it bought was a police surveillance and command estate for the Mauritius Police Force: cameras on main roads, motorways, walkways and traffic centres, a radio trunking network, a central watch and management system and an integrated emergency response layer. The Chinese footprint is therefore narrow and deep rather than broad — one vendor, one lender, one system — and the system it holds is the one that watches the street.

EU activities

Europe's presence in Mauritius is regulatory rather than physical. Mauritius is aligning its data-protection law fully with the EU GDPR and pursuing the European Union's adequacy assessment during 2026. Adequacy would let personal data move from the EU to Mauritius without additional safeguards, which matters to an offshore financial and outsourcing centre; the price of it is that the European rulebook, and each future revision of it, sets the Mauritian standard.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state, Gulf-based operator or Gulf investor held a position in Mauritius's digital infrastructure, its platforms or its financing as at August 2026.

India activities

Mauritians can pay directly on India's payment rails: the UPI-RuPay arrangement agreed in February 2024 is Mauritius's first bilateral cross-border payments agreement, and the domestic rail now runs into India's: MauCAS is joined to the Unified Payments Interface network-to-network, with QR payments settling in Indian rupees through a designated settlement bank.

The same relationship is now reaching the cable layer. Mauritius's move to join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme followed discussions between Prime Minister Ramgoolam and Prime Minister Modi at the AI Impact Summit in New Delhi in February 2026, and was announced on 16 July 2026. Payments interoperability and onward capacity are two of the more durable forms of foreign presence: neither is a building, and both are hard to unwind once traffic depends on them.

Digital sovereignty

Mauritius has told would-be suppliers of a government sovereign cloud that nothing is to leave the island: the technology ministry required all data, metadata, operational data and encryption keys, backups and disaster recovery included, to stay in Mauritius under exclusive Mauritian jurisdiction, with the operator locally incorporated and controlled and the Government Online Centre as the designated hosting site (September 2025). It described wrapped hyperscaler models with local key ownership alongside fully sovereign stacks, and left key custody, portability and exit terms to the procurement itself.

The core rails are run by the state. The central bank owns and operates the MauCAS switch, InfoHighway runs on the government intranet from the Government Online Centre, and the identity system built by a Thales-led consortium is operated by the National Identity Card Unit. Whether the state holds the source code for the identity system, or can change its supplier, was not on record as at September 2026.

The agreements with the hyperscalers are either unpublished or confidential. A non-disclosure agreement has been signed among the parties to Mauritius's entry into the America-India Connect cable while negotiations with Google continue (August 2026). The terms on which Mauritius Telecom's July 2026 memorandum with Amazon Web Services governs data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

For compute, Mauritius Telecom asked NVIDIA for a few hundred B300 GPUs and was quoted about a year's lead time (February 2026). Regionally, the prime minister announced a carrier-neutral green data centre and a "Digital Embassy Village" at the SADC summit in August 2026.

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